



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 5: Motivation, Emotion and Perception

Motivation, Emotion and Stress

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Motivation

Motivation is what energises and directs behaviour toward goals. Intrinsic motivation comes from interest or satisfaction in the activity itself. Extrinsic motivation comes from outside rewards or pressures such as grades, parental expectations, or scholarships. Both can help. Long-term study is often stronger when some intrinsic interest is present.

Emotion and Stress

Emotion involves feelings, body responses, and readiness to act. Stress appears when demands feel greater than resources. Exam periods, fees, and family expectations are common student stressors in Uganda. Moderate arousal can help performance. Very high stress can block retrieval even when you know the material.

Coping on Campus

Break big tasks into smaller steps. Protect sleep before major exams. Talk to a trusted friend or counsellor when load is high. Use short exercise or breathing to reduce acute tension. Coping is part of cognitive performance, not a side topic.

Reflect: Which coping step is most realistic for you before the next exam block?

Closing

The next lesson covers perception.